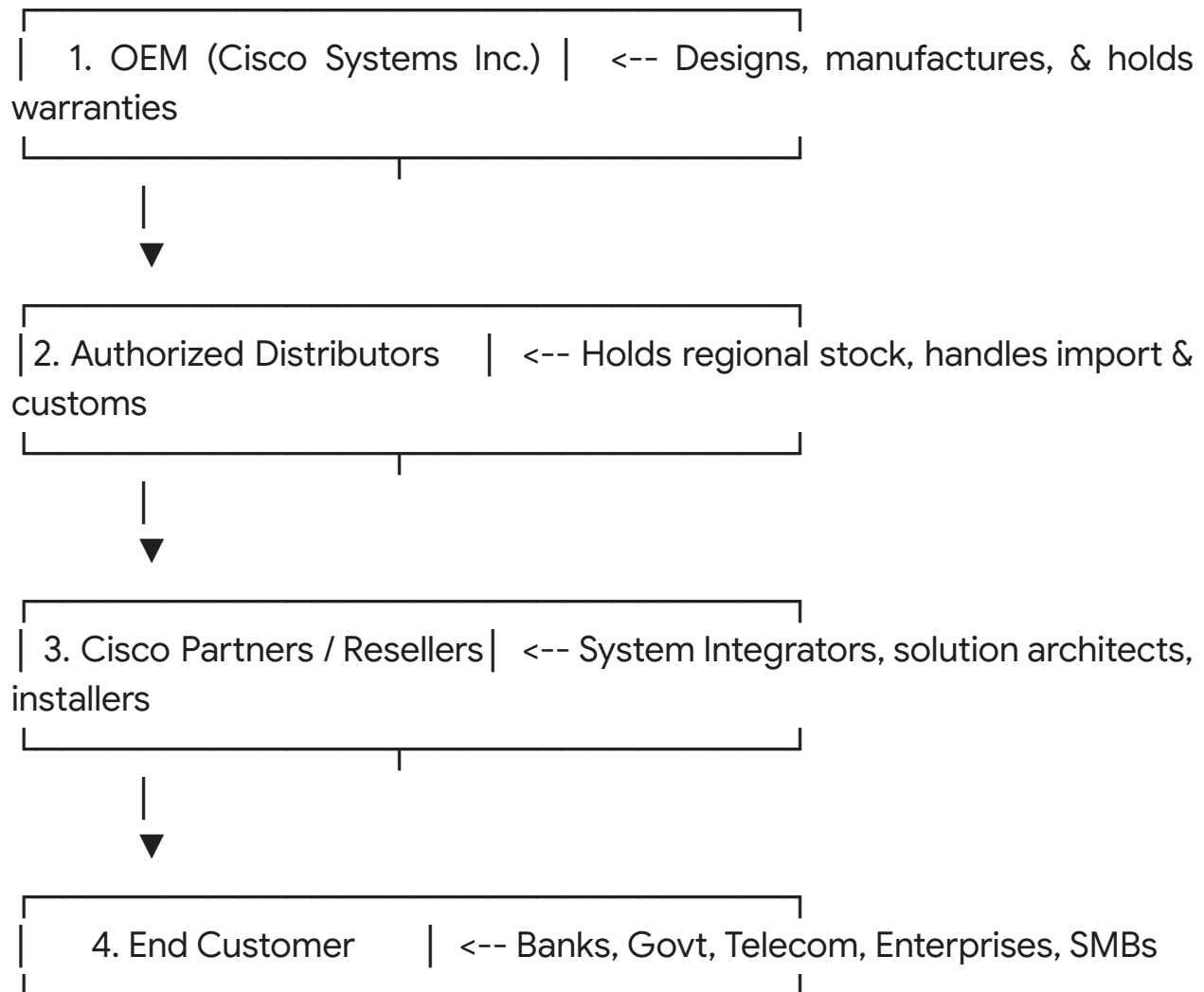


CCNA 200-301: Class Notes — Day 5

Topic: Cisco Supply Chain & Sales Ecosystem in Bangladesh

Cisco operates through a **100% Indirect Channel Sales Model**. Cisco rarely sells hardware, software, or licenses directly to end customers. Instead, it relies on a structured, multi-tier partner network to distribute, implement, and support its enterprise technology worldwide and within local markets like Bangladesh.



1. OEM (Original Equipment Manufacturer) — Cisco Systems Inc.

- **Role:** Cisco Systems Inc. is the primary vendor and designer of hardware, operating systems (IOS XE, NX-OS), cloud platforms, and security software.
- **Responsibilities in the Ecosystem:**
 - **Research & Development (R&D):** Product engineering, innovation, and software updates.
 - **Manufacturing & Serialization:** Producing physical gear (switches, routers, APs) and assigning serial numbers for global tracking.
 - **Warranty & Global TAC Support:** Providing Technical Assistance Center (TAC) escalation and official Smart Net Total Care (SNTC) maintenance services.
 - **Pricing & Deal Registration:** Setting List Prices (MSRP) and granting special discounts/rebates to authorized partners for major projects.

2. Cisco Authorized Distributors (Tier-1 Channel)

Distributors act as the primary bridge between Cisco (OEM) and local system integrators/resellers in Bangladesh.

- **Primary Function:** In-country logistics, bulk importation, warehousing, credit financing, and customs clearance.
- **Key Characteristics:**
 - **Regional & Global Tier-1 Distributors:** Global logistics giants operate regional hubs (e.g., Singapore/Dubai/India) that ship directly to Bangladesh (e.g., Redington, Ingram Micro, TD SYNEX).
 - **In-Country Stocking Distributors:** Authorized local distributors (such as Computer Solutions Inc. - CSI, Digi-Mark, etc.) maintain local warehouses in Dhaka and Chattogram for ready-stock delivery.
 - **Import & Customs Handling:** Manage National Board of Revenue (NBR) import duties, BTRC (Bangladesh Telecommunication

Regulatory Commission) clearance for wireless/radio devices, and Tax/VAT compliance.

- **Services Provided to Partners:**

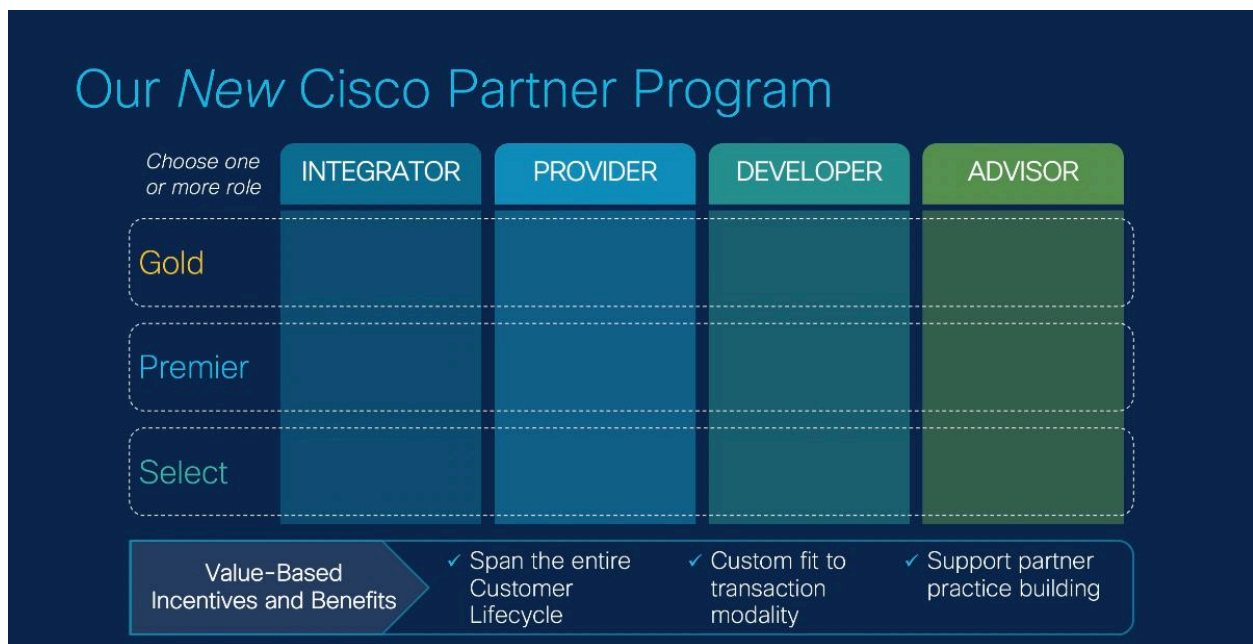
- Extending credit facilities to resellers.
- Providing demo equipment and pre-sales engineering validation.
- Bulk stock availability for quick project turnaround.

3. Cisco Partners / Resellers (Tier-2 System Integrators)

System Integrators (SIs) and value-added resellers (VARs) are the organizations that interact directly with the client, design the solution, submit tender bids, and perform installation.

Partner Tiers & Classifications

Cisco categorizes its partners based on technical certifications (number of CCNA, CCNP, CCIE engineers on staff) and annual sales volume:



Key Responsibilities of Partners:

- **Pre-Sales Consulting:** Conducting site surveys, requirement gathering, and Bill of Materials (BOM) creation using Cisco CCW (Cisco Commerce Workspace).

- **Bidding & Tendering:** Participating in public and private RFPs (Request for Proposals) and e-GP (Government e-Procurement) tenders.
- **Deployment & Configuration:** Rack-mounting hardware, cabling, configuring IOS settings, VLANs, routing, and firewalls.
- **Post-Sales Managed Services:** Providing Service Level Agreements (SLAs), local on-site support, and TAC escalation management.

4. End Customer (The Final Consumer)

The end customer buys the complete solution (hardware + licensing + installation services + warranty) from the Cisco Partner.

Key Customer Segments in Bangladesh:

1. Banking & Financial Institutions (BFSI):

- *Examples:* Bangladesh Bank, Sonali Bank, BRAC Bank, Dutch-Bangla Bank.
- *Use Case:* Core banking network connectivity, high-security NGFW firewalls, Datacenter interconnects (ASR/Nexus), and branch router redundancy.

2. Telecommunication & Internet Service Providers (ISPs):

- *Examples:* Grameenphone, Robi, Banglalink, AmberIT, Carnival Internet.
- *Use Case:* High-throughput Carrier Ethernet switches, ASR/NCS routing backbones, 5G Core infrastructure.

3. Government & Public Sector:

- *Examples:* Bangladesh Secretariat, BCC (Bangladesh Computer Council), Highways & Railway networks, Defense forces.
- *Use Case:* Campus LAN (Catalyst switches), Secure WAN, Smart City infrastructure, national data center expansion.

4. Ready-Made Garments (RMG) & Manufacturing Sector:

- *Examples:* Large textile groups, industrial parks, export processing zones (EPZ).
- *Use Case:* High-density Wi-Fi 6/6E coverage across factory floors, industrial switches, branch-to-headquarter VPNs.

5. Education & Healthcare:

- *Examples:* Public and private universities (DU, BUET, NSU, BRACU), specialized hospital networks.
- *Use Case:* Campus-wide controller-based Wi-Fi, campus LAN, unified communication (VoIP IP Phones).

Summary of the Sales Workflow (Transaction Lifecycle)

1. End Customer issues Requirement / Tender (RFP)



2. Cisco Partner designs solution & generates Bill of Materials (BOM)



3. Partner registers deal with Cisco OEM for discount authorization



4. Partner places purchase order (PO) with Cisco Authorized Distributor



5. Distributor imports gear, clears Customs/BTRC, and delivers to Partner



6. Partner installs equipment & hands over operational network to End Customer